Hosting & Deployment Guide

Since Hugo generates a **static website** (HTML/CSS/JS), you can host it anywhere for free! We recommend **Netlify** for the best balance of features and ease of use.

Choose a Provider

Netlify

Recommended. Fastest setup, free SSL, form handling, and preview builds.

GitHub Pages

Convenient if you already use GitHub, but fewer features than Netlify.

Vercel

Great alternative with a focus on speed and developer experience.

Cloudflare Pages

Leverage Cloudflare's massive global edge network.

Netlify

Best for: Most users, especially those needing CMS support, forms, or headers.

Push to GitHub Ensure your site code is pushed to a GitHub repository.

Import to Netlify

- Log in to Netlify.
- Click **Add new site** > **Import an existing project**.
- Select **GitHub** and authorize.
- Choose your repository.

Configure Build Netlify usually detects Hugo automatically, but verify these settings:

- **Build Command:** `hugo --gc --minify`
- **Publish Directory:** `public`

Deploy Click **Deploy site**. Netlify will build your site and give you a live URL (e.g., `vibrant-name-123.netlify.app`).

GitHub Pages

Best for: Simple sites kept entirely within the GitHub ecosystem.

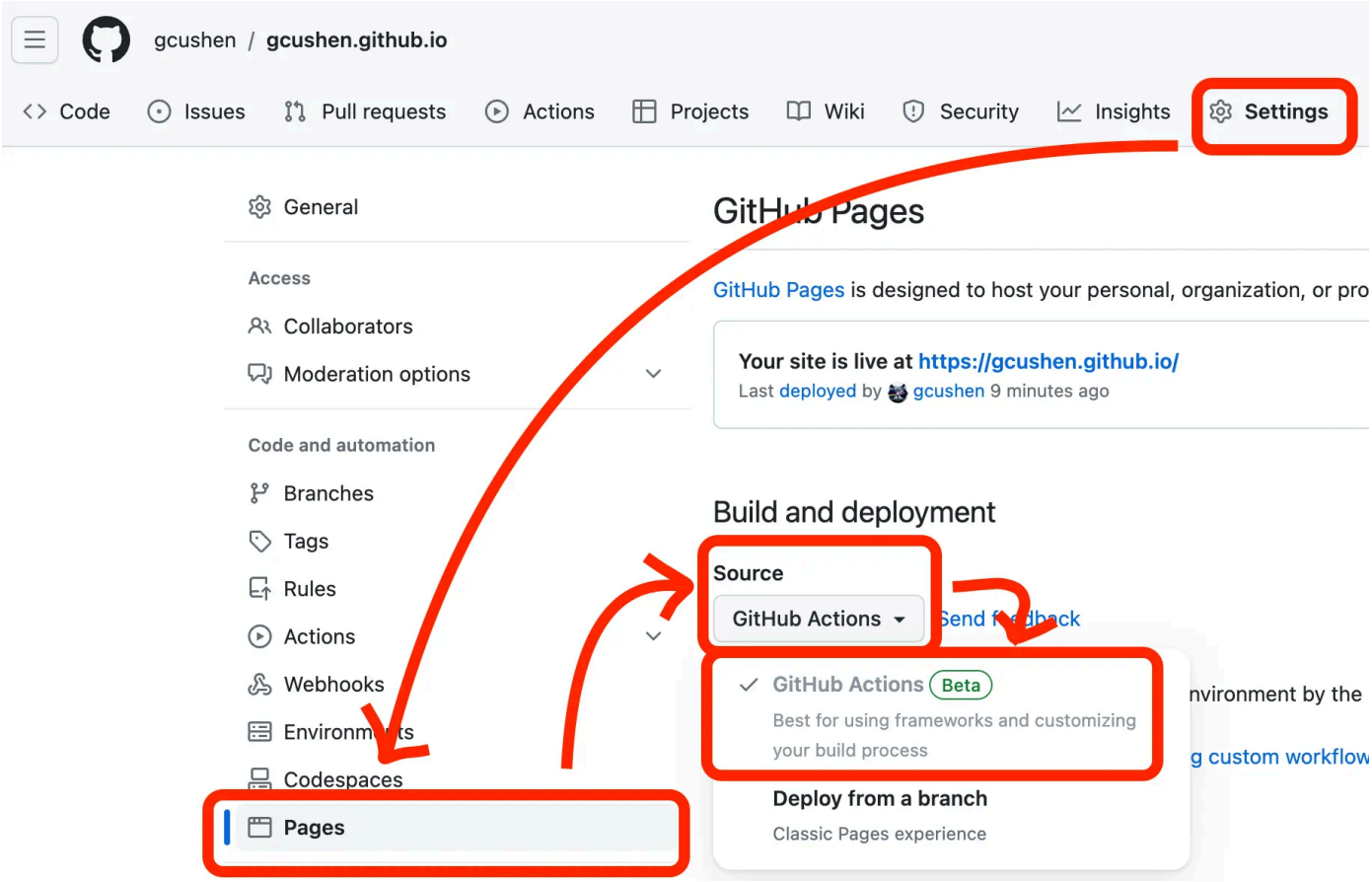
Configure Workflow Create `.github/workflows/publish.yaml` in your repo: [View Workflow File]

Enable Pages

- Go to repo **Settings > Pages**.
- Under **Source**, select **GitHub Actions**.

Trigger Build

- Go to the **Actions** tab.
- Select **Deploy Website** on the left.
- Click **Run workflow**.



Cloudflare Pages

Best for: High traffic sites requiring edge performance.

Connect Git

- Log in to the Cloudflare Dashboard.
- Go to **Workers & Pages > Create application > Pages > Connect to Git**.

Configure Build

- **Production branch:** `main`
- **Build command:** `pnpm install && hugo --gc --minify && pnpm dlx pagefind --source "public"`
- **Build directory:** `public`

Vercel

Best for: Next.js users or those who prefer Vercel's ecosystem.

Import Project Import your GitHub repo on the Vercel Dashboard.

Configure Settings

- **Framework Preset:** Hugo
- **Build Command:** `hugo --gc --minify && pnpm dlx pagefind --source "public"`
- **Environment Variable:** Add `HUGO_VERSION` (e.g., `0.149.0`) matching your `hugoblox.yaml`.

> **Tip**
>
> **Advanced Hosting:** You can also host on Amazon S3, Google Cloud Storage, or via standard FTP by simply uploading the contents of the `public/` folder after running `hugo` locally.

Last updated: Feb 17, 2026